

He totaled the stack of bills again, but the figure came out the same: \$6,764.34. Almost \$7,000! And he knew that he still hadn't found all the bills. He had been so sure they only owed a few hundred dollars that even \$1,000 would have been a shock. But \$7,000! It seemed impossible.

When Linn arrived home, she knew immediately that something was wrong. Jackson was still sitting at the desk, looking at the stack of bills in front of him. "What's the problem, Jackson?" she asked, afraid of hearing the answer.

"I received word from Nick Swartz today that members of the school board have set up a trust and have been paying down our medical bills. That's why we haven't been getting overdue notices from the doctors or the hospital," he said.

"That's great," Linn responded enthusiastically. "So what's the problem?"

"That's not all," Jackson continued in a somber mood. "He also said that there might be a foundation that will handle Jordan's medical expenses from this point on. That will help greatly, won't it? One of the members of the school board is going to help us apply."

Linn was overwhelmed by the news. "Why, that's wonderful! The Lord is meeting every need we have."

"Not quite," Jackson said. "I just totaled up the credit card debts. We owe nearly \$7,000, and I know that's not all of it."

"That's impossible," Linn said faintly as she eased herself into a chair.

"Unfortunately, it's not. We also have a judgment against my wages, as of today. I feel so stupid, Linn. I've been living as if there were no tomorrow and no God. I guess I just assumed that we would have to resort to bankruptcy, so I didn't care how much debt we accumulated. God has been faithful to fulfill His end, but I failed to hold up my end."